

Katherine Root

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Hands on product designer with 15 years across IC, Director, and Head of Design roles. Owned end-to-end design for 0-to-1 AI-powered iOS and Android apps in a regulated healthcare setting. Built and scaled a cross-platform design system used by a team of 8. Deep practice in human-centered design for complex, high-trust products.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Design

Manta Cares | San Francisco, CA | May 2025 – Jul 2026

- AI-native, 0-to-1 startup building apps that help patients navigate cancer care.
- Owned the full end-to-end design process for native iOS and Android apps. Created user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, and interactive prototypes, driving 792 first-time downloads in the first 6 months live.
- Led design and go-to-market for HopeAI, an in-app conversational AI guide. Grew weekly active users ~5x post-launch and reached 1,408 distinct patients in 5 months, with roughly half of conversations continuing past a single exchange.
- Partnered with clinicians, healthcare providers, and pharma stakeholders to translate complex, safety-critical requirements into experiences that were accurate, accessible, and humane.
- Reduced feature-set complexity to remove noise from the core experience, sustaining onboarding conversion of 88–96%.
- Defined and shipped a new brand identity, extending it from digital into print and physical materials for a cohesive cross-channel experience in clinical and oncology communities.

Director of Design

Mighty Networks | Remote | Jul 2020 – May 2025

- Community platform. Post-Series B rapid-growth period.
- Spearheaded a unified cross-platform design system spanning iOS, Android, and web, establishing shared components, patterns, and governance so multiple squads could ship consistent, high-quality UI at speed.
- Remained a hands-on IC on the most critical product initiatives, delivering flows, high-fidelity UI, and prototypes alongside the team.
- Partnered with the C-suite to define product vision, strategy, and development cycles during a critical growth phase.
- Embedded human-centered design methods — research, usability testing, critique — across all product work and evangelized design's strategic role company-wide.
- Hired and scaled a design team to 8; established remote design workflows, ran critiques and design reviews, and mentored designers from junior through senior levels.

Senior Product Designer | Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | Dec 2018 – Jul 2020

Product Designer | Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | Oct 2015 – Dec 2018

Product Designer | Simply Hired | Sunnyvale, CA | Feb 2014 – Oct 2015

Product Design Consultant | CircleBlack | Remote | Dec 2013 – Feb 2014

Lead Interaction Designer | Copper | San Mateo, CA | May 2013 – Dec 2013

Interaction Designer | Launch Design | Los Altos, CA | Aug 2012 – May 2013

TOOLS

Claude Code, Claude Design, Vercel, Lovable, Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Jitter, Jira, Shortcut, Slack

PLATFORMS

Native iOS, Native Android, Responsive Web, Conversational and Agentic AI Interfaces

DESIGN SKILLS

End-to-End Product Design (flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, interactive prototypes), Interaction Design, UX/UI Design, AI-Native Design and Development, Generative AI Product Design, Conversation Design, Design Systems, Rapid Prototyping, Data-Dense Interface Design, User Research, Usability Testing, Accessibility (WCAG), Human-Computer Interaction, Design Strategy, Brand and Visual Design

LEADERSHIP SKILLS

Cross-functional partnership with Product, Engineering, Research, and Clinical/Regulatory stakeholders; Design critique and mentorship; Articulating and defending design decisions to executives

EDUCATION

University of Washington

Seattle, WA | 2008 - 2012

BS Informatics

Focus, Human-Computer Interaction

Minor, Interaction Design

CONTACT

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Portfolio www.katherineroot.com